



Cataract Information Sheet

What is a Cataract?

A cataract is a clouding of the natural lens inside the eye. It is a common condition, especially in older adults, and can cause blurry vision, difficulty with night driving, and glare from lights.

Symptoms

- Blurry or cloudy vision
- Difficulty reading or recognizing faces
- Sensitivity to light or glare
- Trouble driving at night
- Colors appearing faded or yellowed

Treatment Options

In early stages, a change in glasses or better lighting may improve vision. However, cataracts tend to progress over time. When cataracts begin to interfere with daily activities like reading, driving, or doing hobbies, surgery may be recommended. Cataract surgery is the only way to remove a cataract.

What to Expect from Surgery

Cataract surgery is a safe and quick outpatient procedure. It is typically done under local anesthesia and takes 10–20 minutes. The cloudy lens is removed and replaced with a clear artificial lens called an intraocular lens (IOL). There are different types of IOLs available (standard and premium), and your eye doctor will help you choose the one best for you.

Recovery and Follow-Up

- You will go home the same day
- Vision often improves within days
- Use prescribed eye drops as directed
- Avoid rubbing your eye or lifting heavy objects
- A follow-up visit is usually scheduled within 1–2 weeks

Risks of Surgery

Cataract surgery is very safe, but like any procedure, there are risks:

- Infection or inflammation
- Temporary swelling
- Vision changes
- Rarely, retinal detachment or need for further surgery

Most people experience improved vision with few or no complications.